

NT 28 Enrichment

†1. President David O. McKay, “He Is Risen,” *Ensign*, April 2015. “That the literal Resurrection of Christ from the grave was a reality to the disciples who knew Him intimately is a certainty. In their minds there was absolutely no doubt. They were witnesses of the fact; they knew because their eyes beheld, their ears heard, their hands felt the corporeal presence of the risen Redeemer.”

...
“If Joseph Smith’s testimony stood alone, it would be, as Christ said of His testimony when He spoke of Himself, of no avail; but Jesus had God’s testimony and that of the Apostles. And Joseph Smith had other witnesses [who] corroborated [his] testimony, the truth of which was made known by the appearance to them of the angel Moroni...”

What We Need Today

“An unwavering faith in Christ is the most important need of the world today. It is more than a mere feeling. It is power that moves into action, and should be in human life the most basic of all motivating forces...”

“If only men would ‘do His will,’ instead of looking hopelessly at the dark and gloomy tomb, they would turn their eyes heavenward and know that Christ is risen! ...”

†2. Importance of the witness of the Holy Ghost:

John 16:7 “if I go not away, the comforter will not come unto you”

Luke 22:31-22 “and when thou art converted”

John 20:19-20 “Then ... came Jesus and ... he shewed unto them his hands and his side.”

Luke 24:36-48 “And as they thus spake, Jesus himself stood in the midst of them”.

John 21:3 “I go a fishing. They say unto him, We also go with thee.”

Acts 1:3 “To whom also he shewed himself alive ... being seen of them forty days”

Acts 1:8 “But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me ...”

Acts 2:1-4 “And suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind ...”

Acts 4:8-12 “Then Peter, filled with the Holy Ghost, said unto them ... Be it known unto you all, and to all the people of Israel, that by the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, whom ye crucified, whom God raised from the dead ... there is none other name under heaven given among men, whereby we must be saved.”

†3. The Holy Ghost bore witness to Herschel

Pedersen’s investigator. “... When Herschel Pedersen was a stake missionary, he was especially interested in baptizing a certain investigator. Brother Pedersen and his companion had been giving this man the lessons and were excited because they thought the man was close to

joining the Church. In his excitement Brother Pedersen fasted and prayed and spent about fifteen hours preparing a special lesson he thought would convert his investigator.

“Then they went to the man’s home and Brother Pedersen started giving this man his *big* lesson. Soon they could see that the *big* lesson was actually turning this man’s heart away from them. Their investigator was plainly wishing they were someplace else. Brother Pedersen asked this investigator’s forgiveness, candidly admitting that in assuming his big lesson was going to convert this man, he had forgotten to seek the Lord’s will. Brother Pedersen asked for this man’s permission to pray with him before they left. The man clearly wanted to see them go and quickly agreed in order to get them out of his home.

“When they knelt in prayer, Brother Pedersen uttered just a few simple words. He asked the Lord to forgive him and his companion for being unprepared to teach what the Lord wanted taught there. Then he asked our Heavenly Father to let the Holy Ghost witness to the family that the things they had tried to teach were true. Then they left.

The next day the wife of this investigator called Brother Pedersen and said her husband wanted to be baptized. Brother Pedersen was so surprised that he asked her to reaffirm what he thought he had heard. That night, Brother Pedersen and his companion returned to this home to find out what had changed the man’s mind. He said, ‘When you left, the Holy Ghost came, and I sat in that chair till two o’clock in the morning, and my wife and I enjoyed the presence and the comfort and the teachings of the Holy Ghost!’ So Brother Pedersen and his companion had someone to baptize, but only because the Spirit intervened. He learned again that it is only the Spirit that converts.” (Stephen M. Bird, *Prayers That Bring Miracles*, Murray, UT: Aspen Books, 1997, 139-140.)

†4. The Holy Ghost bore witness to Pak Mi-Jung.

Pak Mi-Jung’s two children quickly accepted the gospel, but she didn’t think she could make the commitment to be baptized.

Elder Minor asked her if she had a favorite hymn, and to my astonishment, she got choked up and replied that she loved singing hymns and that ever since she was a little girl, her favorite hymn had been ‘I Need Thee Every Hour’ (Hymns, no. 98). We asked if she would sing that hymn with us, and she tearfully agreed...

“The Spirit was a strong in the room as we had ever felt. As we sang the third verse, emotion overcame her, and her voice dropped out as we continued: [the third verse].

As we completed the fourth and final verse, she was sobbing. As her husband tried to comfort her, she was eventually able to compose herself. She looked me right in the eyes and said, ‘I need to get baptized.’ (Jonathan

H. Westover, "[I Need Thee Every Hour](#)," *Ensign*, April 2015.

†5. The Holy Ghost bore witness to me, by Stephen M. Bird:

I tried out for the Ogden Institute Male Chorus that year [1967] and made it. I almost didn't even try. I was afraid I would fail, but mom said, "Nothing ventured, nothing gained." So I went for it and became the number 10 baritone, which made me eligible to go on spring tour with them.

I'm the sure the Lord inspired me because the group was 80% returned missionaries. Until my association with them, I had not wanted to serve a mission. I was too afraid, but as I sang with them and felt their spirit and listened to their testimonies I found myself wanting to be like them. I thought their missions had something to do with their spirit and so my desire to go on a mission began to grow.

Ladd Cropper was the director and he encouraged me during the tryout. He was the most loving, spiritual person I ever met. I owe my testimony to him and the Male Chorus.

That first quarter I took three institute classes. One was the Male Chorus. The second was the Institute Chorale and the third was a religion class, which was required in order to sing with the Male Chorus.

I enjoyed a great experience that first quarter and signed up for an extra class in the second term (four classes altogether). The spirit I found there so excited me that I dropped all my regular college classes except two and filled my schedule with institute courses to prepare for my mission. I graduated from institute that year and was ready to go.

That spring the Male Chorus went on a tour to Reno, Nevada and Northern California. We sang at the Tri-Stake Center in Sparks, Nevada. Then we performed at one of the chapels in Sacramento and that night we performed at the LDS Institute. The next day we went to San Francisco where we performed in a campus auditorium of the University of San Francisco. We performed that evening at the Oakland Tri-Stake Center in Oakland and the next morning we went to the Oakland Temple. I was going to be baptized for the dead, but when we got there, we learned that the font was being repaired so the women of the group and the non-returned missionaries had a little testimony meeting in the chapel. Many cried, but I didn't bear my testimony nor feel the spirit.

The trip hadn't been entirely spiritual for me. A few of the returned missionaries were smoking or drinking and disregarding brother Cropper's counsel. I even saw a few of them play some poker on the bus once. I didn't think anything of it, but I know it bothered brother Cropper. By the time we got to Oakland I just wanted to go home, even though we had received standing ovations nearly everywhere we went and I had felt the

spirit burn in my heart during some of the songs. I wasn't really aware of the others' behavior until we got to Reno, Nevada.

We stopped at the LDS Institute building in Reno to have a testimony meeting. Brother Cropper said it would be the highlight of the tour. I guess I didn't want to believe him for I wasn't really happy about the delay. I wanted to get on home. I didn't even take off my parka. I know many of the others felt the same way I did. Nevertheless, the spirit began to grow within us at the meeting and I began to feel a desire to bear my own testimony. The meeting started slowly at first with lots of time to stand and speak, but as the meeting progressed two or three persons stood at the same time hoping for the chance to speak. I began to wonder if I would get a chance to stand.

As I sat listening, I burned inside and tears streamed down my face. Someone handed me a Kleenex. I don't know who it was because I couldn't see. Finally, without looking to see if anyone else was standing and hoping that no one was—I stood and bore my testimony. I blurted out my feelings. I forgot all the fancy things I had wanted to say, except that I loved them and that I knew the church was true and that the gospel was a gospel of love. The spirit had burned that into my heart as I heard the Lord's voice whisper reassuringly, *Steve, this is My Church and the Book of Mormon is true. You can feel the love in this room because My Gospel is love.*

At the meeting's end almost everyone was in tears. **Brother Cropper had been praying for us throughout the meeting.** (I didn't pay much attention to that fact then, but now I see how important his prayers were.) Outside we hugged each other and cried. We couldn't stop talking about the experience. That was the birth of my testimony.

†6. The Holy Ghost bore witness to Bill Meelitch who was baptized at midnight in Lovelock, Nevada:

Later that night in Lovelock, a rancher named Bill Meelitch took in twelve Chorus members for the night. He bunked eight in his ranch house and four in his own home. He was present at the chapel when the ward met and fed us. I thought he was a Mormon. He stayed for the concert that night.

After we scrambled onto the bus the next morning, brother Cropper delayed the bus. He said Bill Meelitch was an old friend of his and that prior to last night had not been a member of the church. He said Bill's wife was a member; that he was friendly and loved the Mormons, but as yet had no testimony. He just wasn't sure it was true. But at midnight, Bill had phoned the bishop and asked to be baptized. He told the bishop that halfway through our hymn "I Need Thee Every Hour" the spirit had born testimony to him that the church was true. A dozen missionaries had taught the lessons from time to time and he'd loved them all, but he was never sure. That is, he was never sure until last night.

The bishop responded that the next scheduled baptismal service was a few weeks away and Bill said that wasn't soon enough. Then the bishop said, "How about tomorrow?"

But Bill said, "No, I want to be baptized right now!"

The bishop was shocked. He'd known Bill and his wife Florence about 30 years. Bill was a millionaire rancher and his wife was the relief society president who'd prayed and waited a long time. But he finally phoned brother Cropper and those three with their wives met at the church.

Four members of the Male Chorus who had used it for a tub had scrubbed down the font. Nine people were there at the Lovelock chapel at midnight to witness the baptism and confirmation of Bill Meelitch, a long-time friend of brother Cropper's. I think I know how brother Meelitch and brother Cropper both felt and why brother Meelitch couldn't wait.

Heavenly Father influences us with His wonderful spirit. I had felt the spirit strongly while singing at the other places, but when I sang at the Lovelock Ward, I was tired and, wanted to get home and I never felt the spirit once. Nearly every other place we sang gave us standing ovations. Not so at Lovelock. I thought we'd accomplished nothing special when we finished. And yet perhaps the most special thing was happening as we sang and I never even knew it.

So it was that at midnight the bishop baptized and confirmed Bill a member while brother and sister Cropper shared that golden moment. Some of the Male Chorus acted as witnesses. (They had been bathing in the baptismal font and sleeping at the church).

Altogether, seven people were baptized as a result of our singing tour. One of our members went out with the missionaries door to door and bore his testimony to a young woman and she decided to be baptized. Then a family of five attended our concert at the Oakland Tri-Stake Center and received a testimony. What a great experience to be a part of in some small way.

Those experiences really fired me up for a mission.

When I returned I couldn't get the classes I wanted so I only took two easy classes: rapid reading and health (four quarter hours) and filled the rest of my schedule with every possible institute class I could possibly squeeze in.

†7. My notes of Elder Trevor Ward's homecoming on

July 12, 2015: Serving in Valencia on the east coast of Spain, in a Family Home Evening with a less active family ... [Trevor cannot continue the Spirit is so powerful. **Tears fill his eyes.**] He loved being with them and the food was great. He wanted to stay, but felt the need to leave the house. He and his companion both felt the need to leave. Outside, they had walked only ten or twelve steps, and met Rosie from Honduras. She stopped them in the street, and asked them to teach her the

gospel. They went with her to her home to teach her the gospel. **She had been praying to find the missionaries.**

Her ex-boyfriend had been LDS. She was impressed that she needed his church. She and her family were baptized. This occurred toward the end of his mission. He testified, "I know God lives ... [He paused, overcome by the Spirit.] and I know that He speaks. ... [He paused, again overcome by the Spirit.] I know that families can be together forever through the Atonement of Jesus Christ..."

†8. My notes of Elder Wyatt Duclos's homecoming on

July 12, 2015: Gina was an American serviceman's wife in Vincenza, Italy. She progressed from: "This is a good church" to "your church." After her baptism, she progressed from "our church," to **"This is Christ's church."**

Angela was not interested in religion. She attended church because her boy friend attended. Then she said, "My life is worse when I don't go to church. I'm not as happy."

Before she got baptized, her boy friend broke up with her. Then she moved and became a member in a new ward, but continued to attend, and learn, and grow in her testimony.

Johnny was born in the church and attended, but did not really understand it. After meeting with the missionaries—he changed and became a rock to his friends.

Missionary work is bringing others to Christ. "You are your own number one convert... There were so many lessons where I felt the Spirit so strongly, I can testify 'I know this is Christ's church.'"

"A mission is not easy, but 'the best thing you've ever done.'"

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